Two Roads of Faith

Current company version · generated from the structured master script

CHOSEN: THE STORY BEFORE THE MANGER

SCENE 7 — TWO ROADS OF FAITH

TRANSITION FROM SCENE 6

No traditional blackout.

Mary remains beside the unfinished table for one final breath after Joseph exits. No “Chosen” motif follows her. The silence carries the wound into the next moment.

The stage separates into two simultaneous worlds.

MARY’S ROAD: warm, domestic, safe. Simple elements suggest Elizabeth’s home.

JOSEPH’S ROAD: The workshop remains. The unfinished table, tools, and empty places where his friends stood are still visible.

Mary moves toward Elizabeth. Joseph moves back toward the men. They never see one another.

Two people leaving the same wound in opposite directions.

MARY’S ROAD — ELIZABETH

Elizabeth is occupied with an ordinary household task. She works without knowing Mary is near.

As she works, Elizabeth begins humming quietly to herself.

MUSICAL MOMENT — “O COME, O COME, EMMANUEL”

This is not a performance. Elizabeth is simply singing while she works.

Keep the moment intimate and solo — approximately 40–50 seconds. No background vocals.

The arrangement should begin spare: nearly a cappella or with only the lightest piano/cello support. Elizabeth’s natural gospel color and vibrato may shape the melody without turning the moment into a full gospel number.

ELIZABETH

Shall come to thee, O Israel.

Mary appears quietly at the edge of the space during the final phrase. Elizabeth does not see her yet.

Before entering fully, Mary wipes her face and tries to make herself presentable. She has been holding herself together since Joseph left.

Elizabeth finishes the phrase, returns to her task, then becomes aware that someone is there.

ELIZABETH
Mary?

Mary stops.

Something changes in Elizabeth before Mary explains anything. Elizabeth’s hand moves instinctively toward her own stomach.

ELIZABETH
Oh...

MARY
What?

ELIZABETH
The moment I heard your voice...

Elizabeth feels the child move.

ELIZABETH
Mary.

She looks at her with wonder.

ELIZABETH
Blessed are you.

Mary stares at her.

MARY
What did you say?

ELIZABETH
The child within me moved when he heard you.

Mary’s breath catches.

ELIZABETH
God has done something.

For the first time since Gabriel, Mary does not have to explain herself.

MARY
You know?

ELIZABETH
I know enough.

MARY
You believe me?

ELIZABETH
Yes.

That is what finally breaks through Mary’s composure. Not collapse—release.

Elizabeth opens her arms. Mary goes to her.

JOSEPH’S ROAD — THE MEN

Mary remains with Elizabeth as Joseph’s side comes forward.

Levi, Caleb, Ezra, and Malachi are with Joseph. The ease of Scene 5 is gone. Joseph has told them enough.

CALEB
Mary?

JOSEPH
Yes.

CALEB
Our Mary?

Joseph looks at him.

JOSEPH
Yes, Caleb.

CALEB
I just…

He cannot make the thought fit.

CALEB
Mary?

JOSEPH
That was my reaction.

A tiny breath of recognition, not a joke.

EZRA
She said an angel came to her.

JOSEPH
Yes.

EZRA
And the child comes from God.

JOSEPH
That’s what she told me.

Ezra thinks. No conclusion comes.

LEVI
Then you know what to do.

JOSEPH
Do I?

LEVI
End it quietly.

Joseph looks at him.

LEVI
Don’t shame her. Don’t drag her through the village. But don’t let this destroy you either.

JOSEPH
Levi—

LEVI
You love her. I know.

Beat.

LEVI
But protect yourself.

Malachi watches. Caleb looks miserable. Ezra is still thinking.

BACK TO MARY — THE QUESTION SHE DOESN’T WANT

MARY
Joseph doesn’t believe me.

Elizabeth lets the sentence exist.

MARY
I thought if I told him the truth...

ELIZABETH
He would understand.

MARY
Yes.

Beat.

MARY
He looked at me like he didn’t know what was true anymore.

ELIZABETH
Mary…

Elizabeth waits until Mary looks at her.

ELIZABETH
If Joseph had come to you yesterday and told you this story—

Mary already knows the question.

ELIZABETH
Would you have believed him?

Mary wants to answer quickly. She cannot.

MARY
I don’t know.

ELIZABETH
Neither does he.

MARY
That doesn’t make it hurt less.

ELIZABETH
No.

Beat.

ELIZABETH
It doesn’t.

No easy spiritual answer.

MARY
I said yes.

ELIZABETH
I know.

MARY
I thought saying yes was the hard part.

Elizabeth understands.

ELIZABETH
Sometimes saying yes is only the beginning.

JOSEPH’S ROAD — WHAT DO WE ACTUALLY KNOW?

LEVI
Say you’re done.

CALEB
Levi—

LEVI
What?

CALEB
I know Mary.

LEVI
So does Joseph.

CALEB
Exactly.

Joseph looks at Caleb.

CALEB
That’s what makes this so...

JOSEPH
Impossible?

CALEB
Yeah.

Malachi finally speaks.

MALACHI
Did you pray?

JOSEPH
What?

MALACHI
Did you pray?

JOSEPH
Malachi, I know what happened.

MALACHI
No.

Beat.

MALACHI
You know what it looks like.

That lands.

JOSEPH
There is a child. It isn’t mine. What exactly am I missing?

MALACHI
I don’t know.

JOSEPH
Then why are you talking?

MALACHI
Because neither do you.

Joseph turns away.

EZRA
He’s right.

Joseph turns back, almost offended.

JOSEPH
You’re agreeing with him?

EZRA
Don’t sound so surprised.

JOSEPH
Ezra.

EZRA
We know Mary is with child. We know what she told you. We know what it looks like.

Beat.

EZRA
We don’t know what happened.

JOSEPH
I know enough.

MALACHI
Do you?

Joseph has no patience left for the question.

MARY — FAITH AFTER THE COST

MARY
God was faithful.

ELIZABETH
Yes.

MARY
Then why does obedience feel like everything is falling apart?

ELIZABETH
Because faithful and easy are not the same thing.

Mary looks down.

MARY
I didn’t know my yes would cost Joseph.

ELIZABETH
You can’t give his answer for him.

MARY
And if he never believes me?

Elizabeth does not promise what she cannot know.

ELIZABETH
Then it will hurt.

Beat.

ELIZABETH
And God will still be faithful.

That is harder to receive than reassurance.

Mary is not suddenly happy.

She is steadier.

Elizabeth takes her hand.

JOSEPH — ENOUGH

Joseph’s side returns fully.

JOSEPH
What exactly am I supposed to pray?

MALACHI
The truth.

JOSEPH
I’ve been trying to find the truth all night.

MALACHI
No. Your truth.

Joseph looks at him.

MALACHI
Tell God what you know.

Beat.

MALACHI
Then tell Him what you don’t.

Joseph looks at all four men.

JOSEPH
Go home.

CALEB
Joseph—

JOSEPH
Please.

Beat.

JOSEPH
I need everyone to stop talking.

They understand.

Levi puts a hand briefly on Joseph’s shoulder.

LEVI
We’re here tomorrow.

Joseph looks at him. The word lands after everything “tomorrow” has meant.

JOSEPH
I know.

Levi exits.

CALEB
If you need me—

JOSEPH
I know.

Caleb exits.

Ezra notices a tool out of place. Instinctively he puts it where it belongs, then stops himself from trying to fix anything else.

EZRA
For what it’s worth...

Joseph waits.

EZRA
I still don’t understand it.

JOSEPH
Neither do I.

Ezra exits.

Malachi remains.

JOSEPH
You’re still here.

MALACHI
I know.

JOSEPH
Malachi.

MALACHI
Ask Him.

Beat.

MALACHI
That’s all.

Malachi exits.

JOSEPH ALONE — THE RHYTHM FAILS

Silence.

Joseph stands in the same workshop that was alive with Brotherhood only hours ago.

He picks up his hammer.

BANG

He waits unconsciously for the answer that used to come from the other men.

Nothing.

BANG. BANG.

Still nothing.

Joseph attempts the familiar sequence.

JOSEPH
Measure.

He measures.

JOSEPH
Mark.

He marks.

He cannot continue.

JOSEPH
Come on.

He resets.

JOSEPH
Measure. Mark...

Nothing.

His hand lowers.

JOSEPH
I can’t fix this.

Silence.

For Joseph, that admission is enormous.

JOSEPH’S PRAYER

No polished posture. No sudden eloquence. Joseph sits or leans against the workbench because he is exhausted.

JOSEPH
God...

Long silence.

JOSEPH
I don’t know what to ask.

Nothing.

JOSEPH
I know what it looks like.

He hears Malachi in the sentence.

JOSEPH
I thought I knew what happened.

Beat.

JOSEPH
Maybe I don’t.

That costs him.

JOSEPH
I know Mary.

Beat.

JOSEPH
I love Mary.

Silence.

JOSEPH
If she’s telling the truth...

He cannot finish.

JOSEPH
Please.

Beat.

JOSEPH
Show me what I can’t see.

He waits.

The exhaustion of the day finally overtakes him.

THE DREAM

This is the scene’s transformational LED moment.

Do not repeat Mary’s Gabriel visitation. Joseph’s familiar world remains recognizable at first, but it stops obeying the rules he trusts. Sound stretches. Straight workshop lines subtly lose reliable perspective. The unfinished table becomes silhouette. Depth becomes uncertain.

No clouds. No giant wings. No celestial spectacle for its own sake.

An angelic presence is revealed within the altered world.

ANGEL
Joseph.

Joseph stirs within the dream.

ANGEL
Joseph, son of David.

Beat.

ANGEL
Do not be afraid to take Mary as your wife.

Joseph looks toward the presence.

ANGEL
She told you the truth.

That is the blow.

ANGEL
The child she carries comes from God.

Joseph can barely breathe.

JOSEPH
Mary...

ANGEL
She will have a son.

Beat.

ANGEL
You will name him Jesus.

The name is delivered simply. No musical hit. No graphic. No public payoff.

JOSEPH
What am I supposed to do?

Joseph wants the blueprint.

ANGEL
Do not be afraid.

The presence begins to recede.

JOSEPH
Wait.

The dream does not wait.

JOSEPH
What do I—

THE DREAM ENDS

JOSEPH WAKES

Silence.

Joseph wakes sharply.

The ordinary workshop has returned exactly as it was: table, tools, wood, satchel.

He sits for a moment.

Do not rush this. The audience must be allowed to watch the truth reach him and then watch him realize what Mary endured while he did not believe her.

His eyes find the unfinished table.

He touches it.

Earlier, it represented the future Joseph planned. Now it represents something he has been entrusted to serve without controlling.

He notices the satchel Mary made for him. He takes it with him not as a sentimental prop, but because he is going back to her.

Joseph stands.

No speech explaining the dream. No declaration that Mary was telling the truth.

JOSEPH
Mary.

He exits with urgency.

FINAL CROSSCUT

Before the transition completes, Mary and Elizabeth return softly to view.

Mary is sitting with Elizabeth. She does not know what has happened to Joseph.

She does not know he is coming.

The audience does.

For once, the audience is ahead of Mary.

Music begins carrying us toward Scene 8.

END SCENE 7